

CAPES MONTHLY BRIEF

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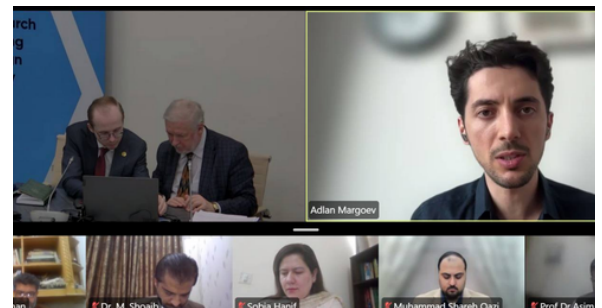
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ADVANCING INDEPENDENT
DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC
& EURASIA



EURASIANISM AND PAKISTAN'S STRATEGIC LOCATION

CAPES in collaboration with Tsargrad Institute, Russia, organized a lecture by Professor Dr. Aleksandr Dugin on “Eurasianism and Pakistan’s Strategic Location” under the aegis of the Distinguished Lecture Series. He is one of the most renowned and influential philosophers in contemporary Russia, often dubbed as “Putin’s brain” by Western media. The online lecture was attended by a wide range of academicians, practitioners, media persons and university students. The event was moderated by Dr. Gul-i-Ayesha Bhatti, Director Eurasia Chapter CAPES.



CAPES-MGIMO ACADEMIC COOPERATION DIALOGUE 2026

CAPES, conducted a high-level academic virtual consultative dialogue with MGIMO University. The event brought together over 20 representatives from some of the leading academic and research institutions from across Pakistan. The dialogue aimed to explore practical avenues to strengthen academic collaboration and advance institutional linkages between Pakistan and Russia.

COLLABORATION WITH NIDS, JAPAN

President CAPES Dr. Khuram Iqbal met with Dr. Masahiro Kurita, Senior Fellow at National Institute for Defence Studies, Japan. They discussed areas of mutual interests and agreed to host Dr. Kurita for a Distinguished Lecture Series event at CAPES in May 2026.





REMEMBERING AMB. SARVAR AZIMOV REMEMBERING AMB. SARVAR AZIMOV: DIPLOMACY AND PAKISTAN-SOVIET RELATIONS (1974–1980)

Dr. Gul-i-Ayesha Bhatti, Director Eurasia Chapter, participated in the roundtable discussion, “Remembering Amb. Sarvar Azimov,” jointly organized by the Russian Embassy and ISSI where she highlighted and appreciated the pivotal role of Ambassador Sarvar Azimov in strengthening Pakistan–Russia relations. Dr. Bhatti also underscored the importance of learning from his approach, especially his emphasis on public diplomacy.



CAPES PARTICIPATES IN THE “JAPAN IN ART” EXHIBITION

CAPES participated in the “Japan in Art” Exhibition, organized by the Embassy of Japan in Islamabad, in collaboration with Pakistan National Council of Arts (PNCA) and Pakistan-Japan Cultural Association (PJCA). The event showcased vibrant paintings and other artworks that highlight the rich cultural bonds between Pakistan and Japan.

CAPES GENERAL SECRETARY COMPLETES HIS DOCTORATE

CAPES is pleased to announce that General Secretary and Director of the North East Asia Chapter at CAPES, Dr. Umair Pervez Khan, has successfully completed his doctorate at Selçuk University, Türkiye, under the esteemed supervision of Dr. Nezir Akyeşilmen. This significant academic achievement is set to further enhance the research quality and intellectual contributions at CAPES.



Struggle for sovereignty, security on Pak-Afghan border

**CAPES GENERAL SECRETARY
DR. UMAIR PERVEZ KHAN**
WRITES FOR DAILY SABAH

<https://www.dailysabah.com/opinion/op-ed/struggle-for-sovereignty-security-on-pak-afghan-border>



“Islamabad maintains that dialogue with Kabul is futile unless prior commitments, particularly those associated with the Doha Agreement, are fulfilled. Pakistan argues that the Afghan Taliban pledged to prevent Afghan soil from being used against other states. Kabul counters that the TTP issue is Pakistan’s internal matter. The deadlock reflects a breakdown of trust. Without credible verification mechanisms, accusations and denials will continue to dominate the narrative. The hostilities have impacted the regional connectivity projects, border trade and refugee management.”

War of Choice

**CAPES NON-RESIDENT FELLOW
MUHAMMAD UMAR**
WRITES FOR THE NEWS

<https://www.thenews.pk/print/1404700-war-of-choice>



“The US and Israeli strikes on Iran assassinated Supreme Leader Khamenei, along with other senior figures. Eliminating the head of a country through external force signals willingness by Washington and Tel Aviv to remove foreign leadership when they conclude the moment demands it. Western governments frequently invoke sovereignty and international law when condemning similar behaviour by their adversaries. That is precisely why actions like this resonate so differently outside Western capitals.”



PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

- Malaysia's Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim backed Pakistan's mediation efforts in resolving the US-Iran conflict.
- Pakistan and China signed an MoU to modernise the livestock and dairy sectors through technology transfer.
- The Malaysian High Commissioner in Pakistan and MPA Amina Hassan Sheikh discussed boosting parliamentary ties and youth cooperation.
- Pakistani company Ghani Dairies has secured 300 Australian dairy heifers to expand milk production capacity and strengthen Pakistan's livestock sector.
- The Government of Japan announced a grant of USD 65,470 to the Pakistan Red Crescent Society to support blood donation services in Islamabad.
- Deputy PM and FM Ishaq Dar, during his visit to Beijing, meets China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi to declare the Five-Point Initiative of China and Pakistan For Restoring Peace and Stability in the Gulf and Middle East Region.
- Former Australia captain Steve Smith is travelling to Pakistan, where he will take part in the upcoming 11th edition of the Pakistan Super League (PSL).
- Federal Minister Dr. Tariq Fazal Chaudhary met Japan's Masakatsu Morotani and reaffirmed Pakistan's commitment to stronger bilateral ties.
- The High Commission of Pakistan in Singapore, showcased the country's rich cultural heritage at the inaugural Open Day hosted by the Asia-Europe Foundation (ASEF).



PAK-EURASIA BRIEF

- The Russian Embassy in Pakistan has invited Pakistani youth to participate in the International Festival of Youth 2026.
- Pakistan and Tajikistan advanced negotiations on a Preferential Trade Agreement to boost bilateral trade and regional connectivity.
- Kyrgyz leadership holds meeting with Pakistani Ambassador Altamash Wazir Khan to discuss economic ties, connectivity, and bilateral cooperation.
- Pakistan's President & Prime Minister held phone calls with Kazakhstan's President Tokayev, congratulating him on the successful outcome of a landmark constitutional referendum.
- Russian Embassy in Islamabad invited Pakistani school students to participate in the Open International Biology Olympiad.
- Sindh Bank of Pakistan is considering opening a branch in Uzbekistan.
- Female MPs from Pakistan and Turkmenistan held a virtual meeting on women's rights, legislative cooperation, and family values.
- Pakistan plans to present a five-year roadmap for increasing trade with Uzbekistan.
- Pakistan and Tajikistan are exploring a direct land trade corridor via Gilgit to enhance regional economic ties.
- Pakistan's Centre for Global & Strategic Studies and Belarus' Academy of Public Relations signed an MoU to enhance institutional collaboration.
- Pakistan has the potential to boost trade with Central Asian states up to \$10 billion, according to the Pakistan Furniture Council.